

APPLIES TO ALL 4 PHASE PROJECTS

Submission Guidelines

What to submit, how to submit it, and how it will be evaluated — one standard across all four phases.

Use alongside any Phase 1–4 Problem Statement

AI Engineering Masters Program

What You Submit

For each phase project, submit **one** of the following two options. Both are accepted — pick whichever honestly reflects your project's state.

Option	What's Required	Best For
A — Hosted Link	A live, working Vercel (or equivalent) URL, plus the GitHub repo link.	Projects with a lightweight backend or one deployable as serverless functions.
B — GitHub Repo Only	A GitHub repo with a README precise enough that a reviewer can run it locally in under 15 minutes.	Projects with heavier local infra (Neo4j, Docker Compose, GPU-dependent serving) that don't deploy cleanly to a free host.

Submission Checklist

- Repo is public, or shared with the instructor account explicitly.
- README includes: setup instructions, architecture overview, tech stack table, and (if hosted) the live URL at the top.
- If hosted: the link was tested in an incognito window right before submission — not just tested once during development.
- If repo-only: someone other than you has followed the README and confirmed it works, or you've done a clean-machine test (fresh clone, fresh venv).
- If repo-only and heavier local infra is required (Neo4j, Docker Compose, GPU-dependent serving), the README says so explicitly up front — e.g. "Neo4j via Docker required — see §2" — since there's no separate form to note this on.
- .env.example is present; no real API keys anywhere in git history.
- The specific domain/option you chose from the Problem Statement is stated explicitly at the top of the README.

How to Submit

Submission is just the link(s) — nothing else is required.

- **Option A (Hosted):** send the GitHub repo link **and** the live hosted URL.
- **Option B (Repo Only):** send the GitHub repo link only.

That's the Entire Submission

No form, no tagging a commit, no separate write-up to fill in. Whatever is on the **main branch** of the repo you link — and, for Option A, whatever is live at the URL you link — at the time you send it is what gets evaluated. Make sure both are in their final state before you send the link(s), since there is no separate step to flag which commit or version counts.

Deadlines & Late Submissions

Submit by the deadline announced for your cohort's phase. If you're blocked by something outside your control (a broken dependency, a host outage), message the instructor before the deadline, not after — silent lateness and communicated lateness are graded very differently.

How Submissions Are Evaluated

Dimension	What's Checked
Correctness	Does it actually do what the Problem Statement's deliverables require — verified live, not read off the README.
Architecture fidelity	Does the build follow the required stages for that phase (e.g. real re-ranking in Phase 1, a real HITL gate in Phase 3)?
Honesty	Does the README accurately represent what's live-wired vs. stubbed/mockred? Overclaiming is penalized harder than an honestly scoped-down submission.
Reproducibility	Can a reviewer actually get it running from the README alone, within the stated time?
Evidence	Are the phase-specific checklist items (from the Step-by-Step Guide) demonstrably true — screenshots, logs, or a live walkthrough?

Academic Integrity

You may use AI coding assistants throughout (see the Vibe Coding Helper Doc) — that's expected, not penalized. What's not acceptable: submitting the reference project itself with cosmetic renaming, or a domain swap so shallow that the underlying logic, data, and prompts are unchanged. The bar is the same architecture, a genuinely different domain, and your own decisions about how the two meet.